



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

tr̥ṣṇā bahuvidhā māyā bandhanī pāpakāriṇī | BRP139.014.1

chittvaitāṃ jñānakhaḍgena sukhaṃ tiṣṭhati mānavaḥ || 14 || BRP139.014.2

saṅgas tu paramo 'dharmo devādīnām iti śrutiḥ | BRP139.015.1

asaṅgasyātmano hy asya saṅgo 'yaṃ paramo ripuḥ || 15 || BRP139.015.2

— Brahmapurāṇa, Chapter 139: Pailūṣa's 'thirst' and the 'sword of knowledge' (Chapter 139), Verse 1

GURU'S INTERPRETATION

The Brahmapurāṇa unveils a profound truth: our thirst, our desires, that "tr̥ṣṇā bahuvidhā," is a multifaceted illusion, a "māyā bandhanī" that binds us and leads us to negative actions. This thirst isn't just for water, but for everything the world dangles before us – wealth, recognition, sensory pleasures. It's the constant craving that keeps you chained to the cycle of suffering. The scripture assures that liberation lies in severing these ties.

How do we break free? With the "jñānakhaḍgena," the sword of knowledge. This isn't literal violence, but the discerning wisdom that cuts through illusion. It's the understanding that these desires are fleeting, insatiable, and ultimately empty. When you wield this sword, when you truly understand the nature of reality, you can dwell in "sukhaṃ," in lasting joy and peace. This is not a passive resignation, but an active engagement with your inner world, a conscious choice to prioritize inner contentment over external gratification.

The passage further emphasizes the danger of attachment, "saṅgas tu paramo 'dharmo." It says that attachment is the ultimate unrighteousness, even for the gods. Why? Because attachment blinds you to the true nature of your Self, your Atman. The Self is inherently detached, "asaṅgasya," yet this very attachment becomes its greatest enemy, "saṅgo 'yaṃ paramo ripuḥ." In modern life, this translates to recognizing the subtle ways attachment manifests – clinging to relationships, identities, possessions. These attachments create anxiety, fear, and ultimately, prevent you from experiencing the freedom and peace that is your birthright. To live a life of detachment is to live a life of freedom.

Therefore, cultivate the sword of knowledge, sever the bonds of desire, and detach from the illusions that bind you. Embrace the freedom of your true Self, and discover the lasting joy that resides within.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

What are the primary attachments that create suffering in your life, and what small step can you take today to loosen their hold?